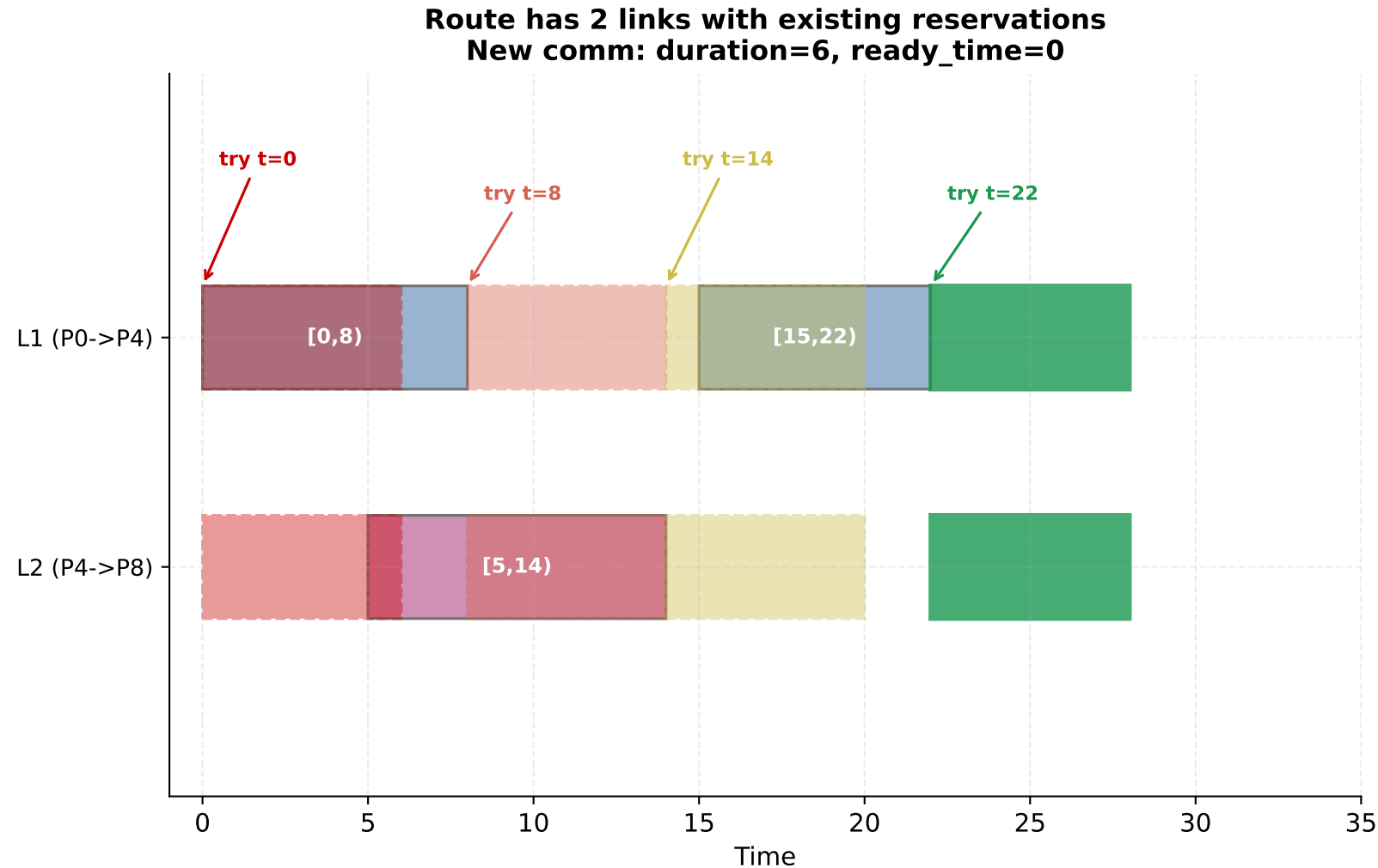


Fig B -- How earliest_route_slot() finds the first joint-free slot on a route



Iteration trace and final result

`earliest_route_slot(route=[L1,L2], duration=6, not_before=0):`

candidate = 0

L1 has [0,8): 0+6=6 overlaps [0,8) -> conflict

-> candidate = 8

candidate = 8

L2 has [5,14): 8+6=14 overlaps [5,14) -> conflict

-> candidate = 14

candidate = 14

L1 has [15,22): 14+6=20 overlaps [15,22) -> conflict

-> candidate = 22

candidate = 22

L1 [0,8): 22 >= 8 -> no conflict

L1 [15,22): 22 >= 22 -> no conflict (back-to-back OK)

Key rule: back-to-back intervals [a,b) and [b,c) do NOT overlap.
This allows tightly packed back-to-back communications on a link.

-> return 22 (start_time = 22, finish_time = 28)